INCIDENT OPERATIONS / MANAGEMENT REVIEW

A targeted operational reset

Where process friction is concentrated, what the evidence shows and which changes are worth testing.

24,918
incident records
Validated operational baseline

5,360
over seven days
22.94% of valid durations

2,737
high-overlap cases
3+ reassignments and 7+ events

DECISION REQUESTED

Approve a 12-week, controlled review and pilot — not an immediate rollout of automation.

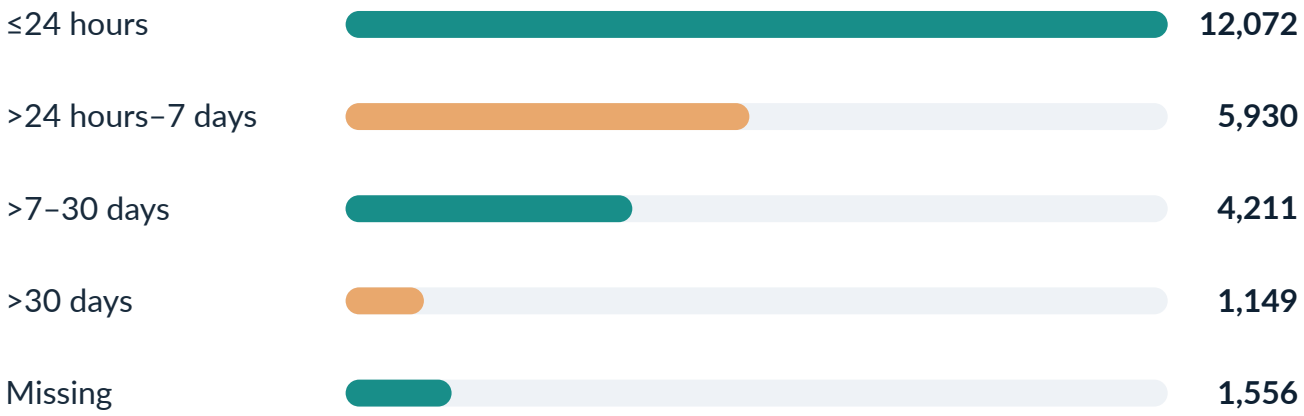
The operational baseline

Beyond overall volume, long-running incidents and missing timestamps need closer attention.

INCIDENTS	MEDIAN RESOLUTION	P90 RESOLUTION	MISSING DURATIONS
24,918	22.1h	15.9d	1,556
Distinct incidents	23,362 valid records	Long-delay tail	6.24% of incidents

RESOLUTION DISTRIBUTION

24,918 incidents, including records with no valid duration



WHAT MATTERS TO MANAGEMENT

5,360

incidents exceeded seven days

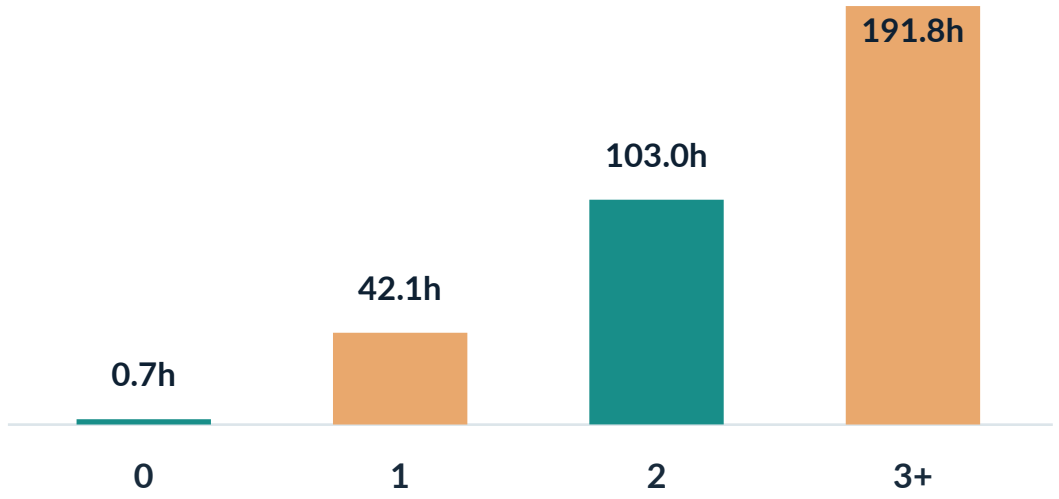
22.94% of records with a valid resolution duration.

1,556 missing durations are a data-quality issue, not proof that these incidents were unresolved.

Repeated handling tracks longer resolution times

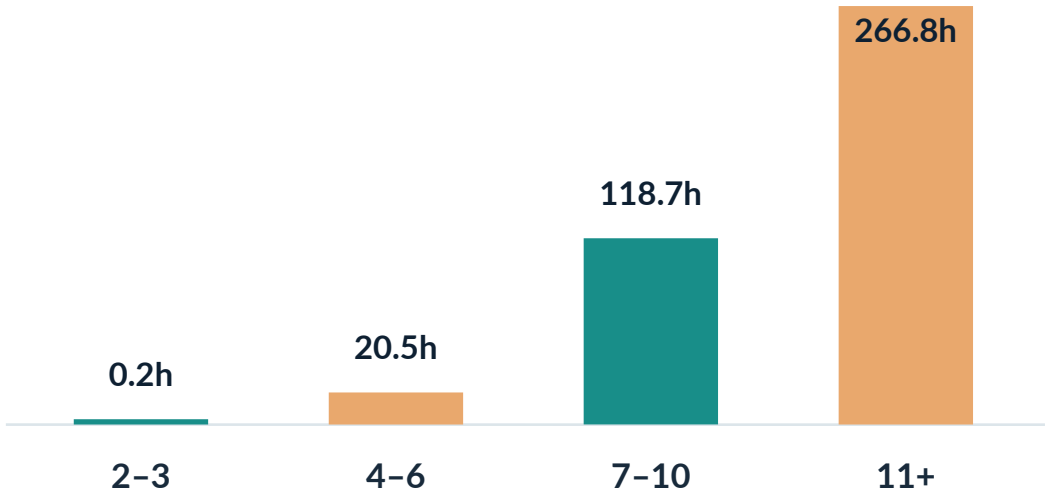
Two clear patterns from Power BI are consistent with the statistical tests in Python.

BY REASSIGNMENT COUNT



Median resolution (hours)

BY HANDLING-EVENT COUNT



Median resolution (hours)

PRIORITY SCREENING COHORT

2,737 cases

3+ reassignments AND 7+ events

Python: group differences are clear (ε^2 0.278 for reassignments; 0.482 for handling events). This does not prove causation.

Routing returns offer a focused starting point

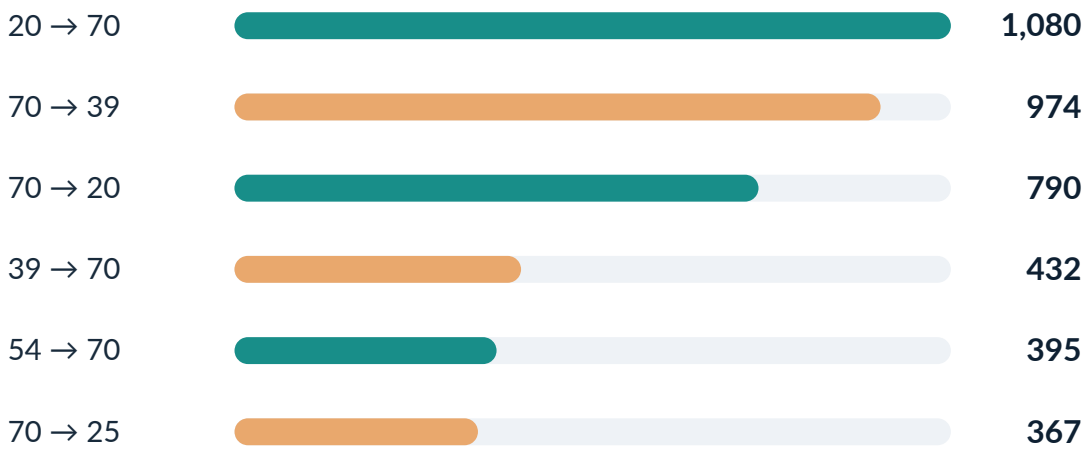
The highest-volume support-group relationships warrant a targeted review — not blanket suppression of transfers.

SUPPORT-GROUP CHANGES
17,914
Across 9,224 incidents

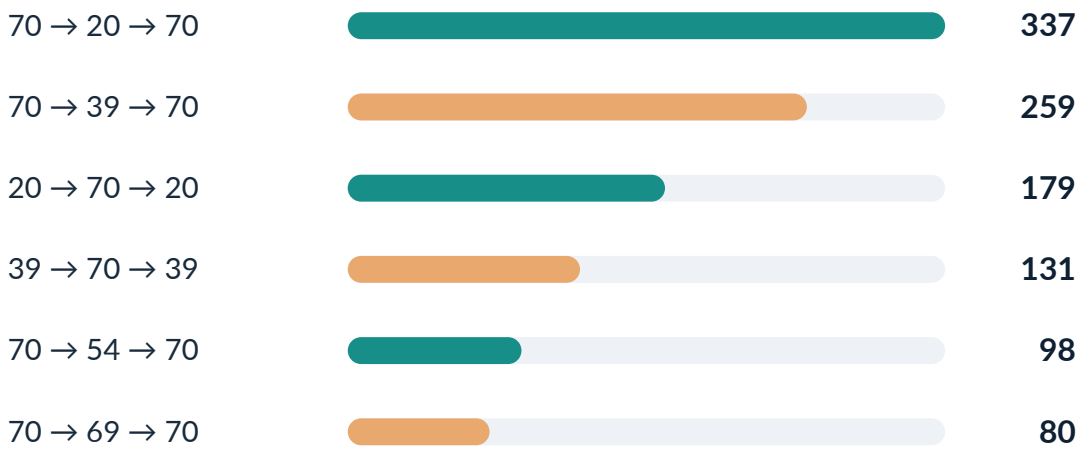
ROUTING RETURNS
3,231
Across 1,963 incidents

TOP FOUR RETURN PATTERNS
906
28.0% of all recorded returns

MOST FREQUENT SUPPORT-TEAM TRANSFERS



MOST FREQUENT ROUTING RETURNS



Investigate Groups 70, 20 and 39 first. Routing-return cases are slower in the raw comparison, but adjusted results cannot establish savings from preventing returns.

Practical recommendations with clear ownership

Five actions to validate, simplify and safeguard the workflow before considering more automation.

OWNER / PRIORITY	PROPOSED ACTION	PROOF / SAFEGUARD
P1 Service desk lead	Review 30–50 repeated-routing cases involving Groups 70, 20 and 39. Record why each handoff occurred.	Tagged root causes and avoidable-loop rate. Preserve necessary specialist escalation.
P1 Incident manager	Trigger a supervisor review at 7+ handling events or 3+ reassignments; check owner, blockers and next action.	Review completion and median/P90 by cohort. Do not auto-close tickets.
P1 Platform / data owner	Reconcile 1,556 missing resolution durations and introduce monitoring for timestamp exceptions.	Root-cause log and completeness checks. Preserve the audit trail.
P2 Process owner	Agree an ownership matrix, handoff checklist and clearer escalation criteria for frequent transfer pairs.	Team sign-off and routing tests. Retain a human override.
P2 Automation lead	Pilot a low-risk routing suggestion or checklist for well-understood cases; require human approval.	Accuracy and override rate. Keep audit logs and a rollback route.

Sequencing principle: confirm the root cause and stabilise the data first; automate only repeatable steps with accountable human oversight.

A 12-week pilot with measurable decision gates

Test in a limited setting, compare like-for-like cases and decide whether to revise, scale or stop.

WEEKS 1–2

Baseline & sample

Audit 30–50 cases. Confirm queue scope, handoff reasons, measures and comparator.

WEEKS 3–4

Co-design & controls

Agree ownership rules, escalation alerts, approvals, security checks and rollback.

WEEKS 5–8

Limited pilot

Test agreed changes in selected queues with process owners and manual overrides.

WEEKS 9–12

Evaluate & decide

Compare outcomes with a suitable control and agree whether to scale, revise or stop.

Decision gates and service-quality safeguards

PRIMARY OUTCOME

Reduce confirmed avoidable returns or handoffs against a suitable comparator.

OPERATIONAL SIGNALS

Track handling events, reassignment rate and median/P90 resolution.

SAFETY GUARDRAILS

Do not worsen reopen rates, priority-specific service levels or unresolved exceptions.

MANAGEMENT DECISION

Approve a limited pilot with a named sponsor and agreed measurements. No improvement or savings are yet demonstrated.

Conclusion: improve the process before automating

The evidence supports a focused intervention — followed by a measured decision on wider change.

01 / MANAGEMENT PRIORITY

Prioritise repeat handling

2,737 cases

Incidents with 3+ reassignments and 7+ handling events are the first cohort to review.

02 / MANAGEMENT PRIORITY

Clarify routing ownership

3,231 returns

Review recurring loops involving Groups 70, 20 and 39 before changing assignment rules.

03 / MANAGEMENT PRIORITY

Strengthen lifecycle data

1,556 records

Investigate missing resolution durations so service performance can be judged reliably.

The decision for management

Approve a controlled 12-week pilot with named owners and agreed safeguards.

Use a suitable comparator; do not claim service gains or savings before evaluation.